

HOW TO WRITE AN ICP

**YOUR ICP IS ONE
SENTENCE. A
BEHAVIOR PLUS A
NUMBER.**

Everything else is a filter.

the template, three examples, two tests

SWIPE →



Vesselin Malev

Founder, The Demand Department

THE VERSION THAT FAILS

2 A FILTER, NOT A TARGET

"B2B SaaS, 50 to 500 employees, US/UK, VP Sales and above." **Ten thousand companies match. Nine thousand aren't buying this quarter.**

fine as a filter • useless as a target

SWIPE →



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THE TEMPLATE

COMPANIES THAT
ARE DOING SOMETHING
VISIBLE RIGHT NOW,
AS SHOWN BY
A NUMBER YOU CAN
FIND IN PUBLIC.

a behavior • a public number

SWIPE →



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EXAMPLE • ENERGY SOFTWARE

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THE RECORD IS THE LIST

Companies that spend the most on electricity, as shown by public utility spend records. **The number is the opener.**

where the list lives • what the opener says • why now**SWIPE →****Vesselin Malev**

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EXAMPLE • GTM SERVICES

5

THE FOUNDER STILL
ANSWERS

Agencies whose founder still does the outbound, as shown by the founder replying to cold email from a personal address and **no SDR on the team page.**

a reply pattern is a public number

SWIPE →

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EXAMPLE • FINANCE SOFTWARE

6 THE DOMAIN TELLS ON THEM

Vendors selling six-figure contracts from an unwarmed main domain, as shown by their MX records and **one external spam test.**

an MX lookup is free

SWIPE →



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THE TWO TESTS

RUN BOTH BEFORE THE LIST GETS BUILT

TEST 1

Can I find the number without buying a database?

TEST 2

Would the opener make sense to someone who never read the pitch?

fail either, rewrite the sentence

SWIPE →

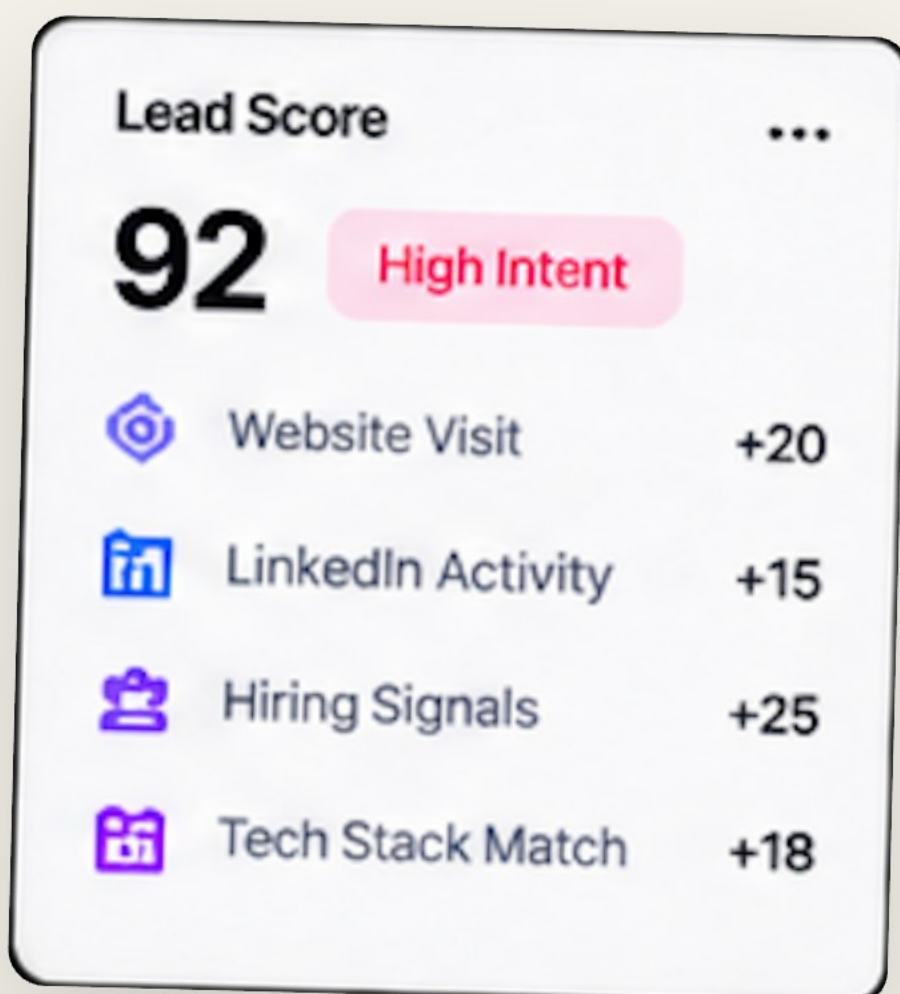


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WRITE IT BEFORE THE LIST.

Every dollar of enrichment spent
before the sentence exists is spent
on the TAM, not the ICP.



one sentence • two tests • then the list



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